CHARACTER CREATION & ADVANCEMENT

Your character is your avatar in the world of Corsair. They are the protagonist of the stories you forge across the Sovereign Moons, and their attributes, learned skills, neural rig chassis, and tactical traits determine their survival on the high frontier.

In Corsair, characters are licensed peacekeepers, warrant-holders, or independent contractors operating under high-stakes institutional oversight. Before distributing attributes, the group decides on the campaign's **Mode of Play**, establishing your crew's legal authority, starship access, and relationship with sponsors.

THE 7-STEP CREATION SEQUENCE

Building an operative follows seven structured operational steps:

1. **1. Mode of Play & Sponsor:** Establish your legal standing (*Freelancers*, *Corsairs*, or *Rogue Corsairs*) and patron.
2. **2. Lineage (Race):** Choose your biological background among the ten lineages of the Sphere.
3. **3. Class MANTLE Chassis:** Choose your cybernetic rig (*Conduit*, *Hazard*, *Pilot*, *Vanguard*, *Weaver*), distribute 7 Class Creation Points, and select an Ability Package.
4. **4. Core Attributes & Derived Stats:** Spend 10 Creation Points across the six Core Attributes (rated 1 to 5), then derive **Endurance** and **Willpower**.
5. **5. Starter Kit & Load Capacity:** Select armor, weapons, and utility rigs within your Max Load: $12 + (\text{STR} \times 2)$.
6. **6. Starting Credits:** Bank your initial allowance of **5,000 Credits**.
7. **7. Starting XP (Skills & Traits):** Spend your Experience Points (6 XP base; 10 XP Humans; 8 XP Hybrids) on Skills (Levels 1–2) and tactical Traits.

MODES OF PLAY

1. FREELANCERS (ASPIRANTS)

- **Status & Resources:** Independent contractors with **no Sponsor** and **no starship**.
- **Campaign Premise:** Operating at ground level. Taking dirt-side security gigs, habitat contracts, bounties, or salvage jobs, operatives rely on passenger liners, cargo transports, and shuttles to travel between moons.
- **Crew Objective:** Building reputation, amassing credits for their own hull, or catching the attention of a major power for a formal charter. Skip the Sponsor step.

2. CORSAIRS (CHARTERED CELL)

- **Status & Resources:** Commissioned peacekeepers with an official cross-jurisdictional legal mandate, **individual Sponsors**, and a shared **Corsair Starship** (such as an RF "Kestrel").
- **Campaign Premise:** The standard Corsair experience. Autonomous cells dispatched to investigate incidents, enforce inter-jurisdictional law, conduct tactical strikes, and resolve geopolitical crises.
- **Sponsor Selection:** Each player chooses an active **Sponsor**. To maintain impartiality, it is recommended that **each player selects a different sponsor**.

3. ROGUE CORSAIRS (OUTLAWS)

- **Status & Resources:** Outlaws with **ex-sponsors** and an unregistered, jury-rigged **ship** (such as a GVI "Rusty Hook").
- **Campaign Premise:** Former Corsairs whose mandates were revoked. The crew takes on questionable contracts—black-market salvage, smuggling, shadow ops, and privateering—while dodging patrol cutters.

SPONSORS & JURISDICTIONS

Depending on your Mode of Play, select a **Sponsor** (for *Corsairs*) or an **Ex-Sponsor** (for *Rogue Corsairs*). Each player should ideally represent a distinct faction:

- **Flotilla:** The independent interstellar defense force. Focuses on fleet defense, orbital integrity, anti-piracy, and peacekeeping.
- **Colonial:** Planetary administrations across the Sovereign Moons. Focuses on territorial law, colonial defense, and resource stability.
- **Corporate:** Multi-system megacorporations. Focuses on corporate intelligence, trade protection, asset recovery, and security.
- **Civilian:** Labor unions, scientific consortiums, and NGOs. Focuses on worker rights, research ethics, and refugee relief.
- **Private:** Wealthy oligarchs or dynasties. Focuses on private collections, high-stakes personal vendettas, and shadow influence.

LINEAGES OF THE SPHERE

Over five centuries of isolation under varied radiation, centrifugal spin, and atmospheres, Newcomer civilization diversified into distinct biological lineages. Your lineage grants attribute adjustments or bonus starting XP:

HUMAN

Adaptable, ambitious, and widespread across every habitat. Possess cognitive versatility. Gain **+4 XP** at creation (total starting pool of **10 XP**).

CRAGGEN

Stout, small-sized humanoids with mineral-dense skin and gemstone eyes. Hardened in dense mine-vaults. Gain **+2 points** distributed between **Finesse** and **Knowledge** (+2/+0, +1/+1, or +0/+2).

NAGA

Cold-blooded, bipedal reptilians with vibrant cranial crests. Exceptional reaction speeds and thermal awareness. Gain **+2 points** distributed between **Agility** and **Instinct** (+2/+0, +1/+1, or +0/+2).

SYLVAN

Imposing, powerful humanoids marked by manes, tusks, and chlorophyllic skin. Biochemically robust. Gain **+2 points** distributed between **Strength** and **Presence** (+2/+0, +1/+1, or +0/+2).

DRAKELING

Nimble, scaly humanoids with swept horns and serpentine tails. Reptilian reflex with human drive. Gain **+2 XP** (8 XP total), plus **+1 Agility** or **+1 Instinct**.

ELF

Graceful, slender humanoids with pointed ears and chlorophyllic pigmentation. Sylvan resilience with human social drive. Gain **+2 XP** (8 XP total), plus **+1 Strength** or **+1 Presence**.

GNOME

Inquisitive, slender humanoids with iridescent eye/hair pigmentation. Natural curiosity and technical dexterity. Gain **+2 XP** (8 XP total), plus **+1 Finesse** or **+1 Knowledge**.

DWARF

Dense, subterranean humanoids combining crystalline deposits with reinforced frames. Sylvan bulk with Craggen endurance. Gain **+1 Strength** or **+1 Presence**, plus **+1 Finesse** or **+1 Knowledge**.

KOBOLD

Cunning reptilians crowned with natural bone masks. Naga reflexes with Craggen precision. Gain **+1 Agility** or **+1 Instinct**, plus **+1 Finesse** or **+1 Knowledge**.

TROLL

Towering, horned humanoids with thick hides and tusks. Sylvan mass with Naga predatory instincts. Gain **+1 Strength** or **+1 Presence**, plus **+1 Agility** or **+1 Instinct**.

> **RACIAL BONUS TIMING**
>
> Racial attribute adjustments are applied prior to Creation Point distribution. Stepping an Attribute from 4 to 5 always costs 2 Creation Points regardless of racial bonuses.

CORE ATTRIBUTES

Every operative is defined by six Core Attributes representing baseline physical conditioning and cognitive capacity on a scale from 1 to 10 (with 1 being standard untrained ability and 10 representing peak potential).

PHYSICAL ATTRIBUTES

- **Strength:** Muscular force, skeletal leverage, and athletic power. Used for forcing jammed bulkhead seals, grappling opponents, wielding heavy ordnance, and carrying combat loads.
- **Agility:** Whole-body speed, balance, kinesthetic coordination, and physical reflexes. Crucial for dodging fire, vaulting obstacles, and zero-gravity maneuvering.
- **Finesse:** Manual dexterity, fine motor skills, and surgical hand-eye coordination. Used for precision marksmanship, field surgery, lockpicking, and delicate electronics work.

MENTAL ATTRIBUTES

- **Knowledge:** Technical education, data analysis, and memory recall. Used for slicing computer nodes, repairing starship reactors, and deciphering Precursor archives.
- **Presence:** Force of personality, commanding bearing, and social resolve. Vital for interrogations, diplomatic de-escalation, and tactical command.
- **Instinct:** Gut intuition, situational awareness, and split-second subconscious perception. Used for spotting concealed ambushes, reading body language, and reacting to surprise hazards.

DERIVED ATTRIBUTES

From your Core Attributes, calculate two vital derived ratings:

- **Endurance:** Physical resilience and pain tolerance. Equal to your **second-highest Physical Attribute** (Strength, Agility, or Finesse).
- **Willpower:** Mental fortitude, stress management, and emotional resistance. Equal to your **second-highest Mental Attribute** (Knowledge, Presence, or Instinct).

DISTRIBUTING CREATION POINTS

All six Core Attributes start at a baseline rating of **1** (`1 / 1 / 1 / 1 / 1 / 1`). You have **10 Creation Points** to distribute:

- Increasing an Attribute from **1 to 4** costs **1 point** per increase.
- Increasing an Attribute from **4 to 5** costs **2 points**.
- **Starting Cap:** The maximum rating for any Core Attribute at creation is **5**.

CLASS CHASSIS (MANTLE RIG)

Your Class is a proprietary **MANTLE** (*Modular Adaptive Neural Transmission Linked Equipment*)—an aerospace-grade cybernetic or technological chassis interfacing directly with your nervous system via a permanent **Neural Control Chip (NCC)** and spinal shunt.

Due to neural bandwidth limits, an operative can have only **one active MANTLE chassis equipped at a time**.

THE FIVE STARTING CHASSIS

- **Conduit:** Elemental shock trooper channeling electrical and thermal volatility. *Class Attributes:* Flame, Frost, Lightning.
- **Hazard:** Combat alchemist armed with a pressurized Catalyst Chamber. *Class Attributes:* Venom, Hazard, Serum.
- **Pilot:** Neuro-synced exoskeleton and autonomous exodrone operator. *Class Attributes:* Power, Speed, Precision.
- **Vanguard:** High-mobility frontline breaker with a morphing kinetic board. *Class Attributes:* Shield, Glider, Cannon.
- **Weaver:** Nanite artisan manipulating a living fluid swarm. *Class Attributes:* Create, Control, Modify.

CLASS ATTRIBUTES BUDGET

All three Class Attributes start at **1** (`1 / 1 / 1`). Spend **7 Class Creation Points** to increase them (1 to 4 costs 1 point; 4 to 5 costs 2 points; starting cap is 5). Select **one starting Class Ability Package** from your class chapter.

STARTER KIT & OUTFITTING

Every operative receives standard survival gear for life on the fringe, including tactical communications, protective armor, weapons, and a specialized utility rig.

THE LOAD CAPACITY SYSTEM

All gear is governed by the **Load** system, representing mass, bulk, and holstering awkwardness. An operative's carrying limit is determined directly by their physical power:

> **Maximum Load Capacity = 12 + (Strength × 2)**

This capacity is an absolute operational limit; an operative cannot carry gear exceeding this value under any circumstances. Reserve spare Load for field salvage, power cells, and munitions.

1. UNIVERSAL COMMUNICATIONS

- **1 Commlink** (Load 0 | Long-Range Tactical Comms).

2. PERSONAL ARMOR (CHOOSE 1)

- **Padded Flightsuit** (Protection 2 | Load 1) — *Lightweight, pressurized jumpsuit with minimal bulk.*
- **Armored Jacket** (Protection 3 | Load 2) — *Durable ballistic coat lined with reinforced composite inserts.*

3. MELEE WEAPON (CHOOSE 1)

Select one melee tier your **Strength** satisfies (1H weapons require two hands if below Min STR). Pick the damage type matching your favored attribute pair:

- **Piercing (Agility + Finesse):** Adds lower of Agility or Finesse to damage.
- **Slashing (Agility + Strength):** Adds lower of Agility or Strength to damage.
- **Striking (Strength + Finesse):** Adds lower of Strength or Finesse to damage.

Light Melee (Min STR 1 | Load 1/2 | Dmg +0):

- Shiv / Stiletto (Piercing)
- Combat Knife (Slashing)
- Knuckleduster (Striking)

Tactical Melee (Min STR 2 | Load 1 | Dmg +1):

- Dagger (Piercing)
- Hatchet / Machete (Slashing)
- Baton / Club (Striking)

Heavy Melee (Min STR 3 | Load 2 | Dmg +2):

- Shortsword (Piercing)
- Boarding Axe (Slashing)
- Mace / Crowbar (Striking)

4. FIREARM (CHOOSE 1)

Select one firearm based on desired engagement range. Ranged tests always pair weapon **Accuracy** at the target's range band with **Finesse**:

Close-Quarters (Short Range: 0–5 spaces / ~0–20m):

- **Service Pistol:** 1H | Load 1 | Dmg +1 | RoF 1 | Acc: 3 / 2 / 1 / -
- **Compact SMG:** 2H | Load 2 | Dmg +1 | RoF 2 | Acc: 4 / 3 / 1 / -
- **Combat Shotgun:** 2H | Load 3 | Dmg +3 | RoF 1 | Acc: 4 / 3 / 0 / -

Mid-Range & General (Medium Range: 6–12 spaces / ~20–40m):

- **Heavy Revolver:** 1H | Load 1 | Dmg +2 | RoF 0 | Acc: 3 / 2 / 1 / -
- **Assault Carbine:** 2H | Load 3 | Dmg +2 | RoF 2 | Acc: 3 / 3 / 2 / 1
- **Assault Rifle:** 2H | Load 3 | Dmg +2 | RoF 2 | Acc: 2 / 4 / 3 / 1

Long-Range & Standoff (Long/Extreme: 13–20+ spaces / ~40–80+m):

- **Battle Rifle:** 2H | Load 3 | Dmg +4 | RoF 0 | Acc: 2 / 3 / 4 / 2
- **Marksman Rifle (DMR):** 2H | Load 4 | Dmg +4 | RoF 1 | Acc: 1 / 3 / 5 / 3
- **Sniper Rifle:** 2H | Load 4 | Dmg +5 | RoF 0 | Acc: 0 / 2 / 5 / 4

5. SPECIALIZED UTILITY KIT (CHOOSE 1)

- **Medic Kit:** 1 Field Medi-Kit (Medicine 3 | Cap 3 | Lesser Physical) & 1 Neuro-Stabilizer Inhaler (Medicine 3 | Cap 3 | Lesser Mental).
- **Grenadier Kit:** 1 Tactical Grenade Rig (Cap 3) & 1 Grenade Launcher Rig (Medium Range | Load 2).
- **Techie Kit:** 1 "Spider" Cyberdeck (Interfacing 3, Hacking 2 | Load 2) & 1 Proximity Sensor (Scouting 4m | Load 1/2).
- **Mobility Kit:** 1 Standard Grapple Launcher (Mobility 3 | Range 8m | Cap 3) & 1 Gecko Climbing Kit (Surface Adhesion | Load 1).
- **Trench Kit:** 1 Deployable Cover (Medium Cover +2 | 24 HP | Load 3) & 1 Mechanic's Kit (Tinkering 2, Locksmith 2 | Load 2).

STARTING CREDITS

Every operative begins with **5,000 Credits** to purchase additional specialized ordnance, reserve ammunition, or bank for operational expenses.

SKILLS & STARTING EXPERIENCE

While Attributes represent raw physical and mental power, Skills represent trained operational expertise in specific fields, providing reliable Upgrades when the pressure mounts.

SKILL RATINGS & UPGRADES

Skills are rated from 1 to 3. When you make a test using the Attribute Pair associated with your skill, you automatically receive a number of **Upgrades** equal to your skill rating:

- **Skill Level 1:** Trained operative. You receive **+1 Upgrade** on relevant tests.
- **Skill Level 2:** Seasoned specialist. You receive **+2 Upgrades** on relevant tests.
- **Skill Level 3:** Sector-renowned authority. You receive **+3 Upgrades** on relevant tests.

FLEXIBLE SKILL NAMING

A core feature of the Corsair engine is narrative flexibility. You are encouraged to invent descriptive, character-defining names for your skills. The only mechanical rule is that the skill must logically connect to its assigned Attribute Pair:

- **Accuracy + Finesse:** *Gunslinging, Precision Marksmanship, Standoff Sniping.*
- **Finesse + Agility:** *Zero-G Acrobatics, Sleight of Hand, Blade Dancer.*
- **Knowledge + Presence:** *Corporate Law, Crisis De-escalation, Xeno-Linguistics, Tactical Analysis.*
- **Strength + Agility:** *Boarding Breacher, Free-Running, Kinetic Wrestling.*
- **Knowledge + Finesse:** *Cyber-Infiltration, Field Surgery, Explosive Ordnance Disposal.*
- **Instinct + Presence:** *Hostage Negotiation, Streetwise Grift, Interrogation.*

While the skill name injects distinct flavor into your character, the mechanical Upgrades apply to **any test** rolled with that Attribute Pair.

STARTING XP BUDGET

Rather than tracking separate pools of skill points and talent slots, characters receive flat **Experience Points (XP)** at creation.

You may spend this starting XP freely to purchase Skills, acquire Traits, or combine both:

- **Baseline Starting Pool: 6 XP**.
- **Human Operatives:** Gain +4 XP for **10 XP total**.
- **Hybrid Lineages (Drakeling, Elf, Gnome):** Gain +2 XP for **8 XP total**.

SKILL COSTS

- **Level 1 Skill:** Costs **2 XP** (+1 Upgrade).
- **Level 2 Skill:** Costs **4 XP** (6 XP cumulative; +2 Upgrades).
- **Level 3 Skill:** Costs **6 XP** (12 XP cumulative; +3 Upgrades).
- **Creation Skill Cap:** The maximum rating for any Skill at character creation is **Level 2** (preserving Level 3 as an elite distinction earned in active play).

PURCHASING TRAITS

Operatives can spend starting XP directly to acquire standalone **Traits** from the catalog. Each Trait has a flat cost between **2 XP and 8 XP** with zero prerequisite tree gatekeeping.

SAMPLE STARTING BUILDS

With a baseline pool of 6 XP, operatives enjoy complete freedom to define their starting tactical profile:

- **The Generalist:** Purchase three separate Level 1 Skills (3 × 2 XP = 6 XP) for broad coverage.
- **The Dedicated Specialist:** Invest all 6 XP into a single signature Level 2 Skill (2 XP + 4 XP = 6 XP).
- **The Pure Tactician:** Purchase standalone Traits, such as *Tough as Nails* (6 XP) or *Brawler* (2 XP) + *Counter Striker* (4 XP).
- **The Balanced Operative:** Combine one Level 1 Skill (2 XP) and one 4 XP Trait (such as *Marksman*, *Iron Will*, or *Healer*).
- **Human Versatility:** A Human with 10 XP can acquire a Level 2 Skill (6 XP) plus two Level 1 Skills (4 XP), or pair a top-tier Trait like *Controlled Blast* (8 XP) with a Level 1 Skill (2 XP).

TRACKING SHEETS

Record your stats, load, and chassis abilities on the official printable **Corsair Character Sheet**. For crews operating a shared vessel, use the **Corsair Crew Sheet** to manage bridge stations, vessel damage, and collective cargo.

CREATION IN ACTION: JAX

To illustrate how the creation sequence operates in practice, here is the complete build walkthrough for **Jax**, a licensed Corsair peacekeeper operating under a Flotilla interdiction warrant:

STEP 1: MODE OF PLAY & SPONSOR

Jax's cell plays a standard **Corsair (Chartered Cell)** campaign aboard an RF "Kestrel" light cutter. Jax selects the **Flotilla** as his sponsor, granting him a lawful cross-jurisdictional warrant to apprehend system fugitives, investigate orbital breaches, and intercept pirate raiders.

STEP 2: LINEAGE (RACE)

Jax is a **Human**. Rather than innate attribute adjustments, Jax receives **+4 bonus starting XP** (for a starting budget of **10 XP**).

STEP 3: CLASS MANTLE CHASSIS

Jax equips the **Vanguard** chassis—a high-mobility frontline rig featuring a morphing kinetic board. His three Class Attributes start at `1 / 1 / 1`. With **7 Class Creation Points**, he allocates:

- **Shield 4** (3 pts from 1 to 4)
- **Cannon 4** (3 pts from 1 to 4)
- **Glider 2** (1 pt from 1 to 2)

Starting Package: He selects the **Vanguard Defense Package** (unlocking *Bulwark Anchor*, *Aegis Intercept*, and *Kinetic Deflection*).

STEP 4: CORE ATTRIBUTES & DERIVED STATS

Jax starts at `1 / 1 / 1 / 1 / 1 / 1` and allocates his **10 Creation Points**:

- **Strength 4** (3 pts) & **Finesse 4** (3 pts)
- **Agility 3** (2 pts)
- **Knowledge 2** (1 pt) & **Instinct 2** (1 pt)
- **Presence 1** (0 pts)

Derived Stats: Second-highest Physical is **Endurance 4**. Second-highest Mental is **Willpower 2**. Physical Condition tracks have **8 segments each** (4 + 4); Mental tracks have **6 segments each** (4 + 2).

STEP 5: STARTER KIT & LOAD BUDGETING

Carrying limit: $\text{Max Load} = 12 + (\text{STR } 4 \times 2) = 20 \text{ Load}$.

- **Commlink:** Load 0 (Tactical communications).
- **Armored Jacket:** Protection 3 | Load 2.
- **Boarding Axe:** Heavy Melee Slashing | Load 2 | Dmg +2 | Pairs *Agility + Strength*.
- **Heavy Revolver:** Handgun, 1H | Load 1 | Dmg +2 | RoF 0 | Acc: 3 / 2 / 1 / - | Pairs *Accuracy + Finesse*.
- **Trench Kit:** Deployable Cover (Load 3) & Mechanic's Kit (Load 2) = Load 5.

Total Load: 10 / 20 Load (leaving **10 spare Load** for ammo, field salvage, and contraband evidence).

STEP 6: STARTING CREDITS

Jax banks his baseline reserve of **5,000 Credits**.

STEP 7: SKILLS & TRAITS (STARTING XP)

With **10 XP** as a Human, Jax purchases:

- **Skill — Gunslinging 1 (Accuracy + Finesse):** Costs 2 XP (+1 Upgrade on ranged marksmanship tests).
- **Trait — Gunslinger:** Costs 4 XP. Ignores the 3 Downgrades for firing ranged weapons while in Close Quarters Combat (CQC).
- **Trait — Marksman:** Costs 4 XP. Treats targets as 1 Range Band closer or further for weapon Accuracy.

JAX — CHARACTER SUMMARY

Human Corsair | Flotilla Sponsor | Vanguard Chassis Lvl 1
Attributes: STR 4, FIN 4, AGI 3, KNO 2, INS 2, PRE 1
Derived: Endurance 4, Willpower 2 | **Load:** 10 / 20
Class Attributes: Shield 4, Cannon 4, Glider 2
Skills: Gunslinging 1 (Accuracy + Finesse; +1 Upgrade)
Traits: Gunslinger (4 XP), Marksman (4 XP)
Armory: Armored Jacket (Prot 3), Heavy Revolver (Dmg +2), Boarding Axe (Dmg +2), Trench Kit, Commlink | **Credits:** 5,000

CONDITION & TRAUMA

Condition represents an operative's capacity to endure trauma. Instead of tracking an abstract pool of hit points, resilience is divided into two distinct categories: **Physical Condition** and **Mental Condition**.

Physical Condition measures structural bodily integrity against kinetic trauma, thermal burns, and toxins, governed by **Endurance**. **Mental Condition** measures cognitive resilience, emotional fortitude, and sanity under sensory shock and psychological terror, governed by **Willpower**.

THE THREE SEQUENTIAL TRACKS

Both Physical and Mental Condition are divided into three sequential **Tracks** (Track I, Track II, and Track III). Whenever your character suffers damage or mental stress, mark off segments starting on Track I. Once a Track becomes completely full, any subsequent damage naturally overflows into the next Track:

> **Track Capacity = 4 + Derived Attribute**

(4 + Endurance for Physical Tracks; 4 + Willpower for Mental Tracks)

DAMAGE TYPES: LIGHT VS. AGGRAVATED

Damage is tracked as either **Light Wounds** (standard combat fatigue and surface trauma) or **Aggravated Wounds** (severe tissue destruction or psychic fracture):

- **Light Wounds:** Standard damage instances that fill open segments. Readily restored through basic medical supplies and short rests.
- **Aggravated Wounds:** When an incoming source of damage overflows the remaining capacity of a Track, the excess points convert filled Light Wounds on that filled Track into **Aggravated Wounds**. Aggravated Wounds represent deep structural trauma that cannot be healed through basic Lesser Healing.

ATTRIBUTE PENALTIES: IMPAIRED & CRIPPLED

Filling a Condition Track inflicts severe strain on an operative's capabilities:

- **Impaired (Light Wounds):** When a Track is completely filled with Light Wounds, select and mark one corresponding Attribute on your sheet (a Physical Attribute for Physical Tracks, or a Mental Attribute for Mental Tracks). That Attribute becomes **Impaired**. From that moment forward, any test involving that Impaired Attribute suffers **1 Downgrade**.
- **Crippled (Aggravated Wounds):** If an individual Track becomes completely filled with Aggravated Wounds, the marked Attribute becomes **Crippled**. Any test involving a Crippled Attribute suffers **2 Downgrades** instead.

CONSEQUENCES OF FULL CONDITION

Filling all three sequential Tracks brings critical consequences:

- **Physical Collapse:** When all three Physical Tracks are filled with any combination of Light or Aggravated Wounds, your character falls **Unconscious** and cannot act until at least one segment is cleared. If every single segment across all three Physical Tracks becomes filled with **Aggravated Wounds**, your character **Dies**.
- **Mental Breakdown:** When all three Mental Tracks become filled, your character is mentally overwhelmed and **cannot earn or spend Gambit Dice** (though existing Gambit dice remain banked) until at least one segment is cleared. If all three Mental Tracks are filled entirely with **Aggravated Wounds**, your psyche collapses, leaving your character **susceptible to suggestions, commands, and intimidation** in the exact same manner as non-player characters.

HEALING ACROSS SCOPES

Recovery is divided into two distinct medical methodologies based on trauma severity: **Lesser Healing** restores standard Light Wounds, while **Greater Healing** represents intensive medical intervention capable of repairing Aggravated Wounds.

Opportunities for recovery depend directly on the scene's pacing:

- **Moment-to-Moment Pacing:** Under active fire, healing is restricted to rapid tactical items (such as Field Medi-Kits, Neuro-Stabilizers, or class chems), functioning according to their specific item capacity.
- **Place-to-Place Pacing (Short Rest):** When the cell catches its breath during exploration, operatives access Lesser Healing through a Short Rest. Roll a **Success Test** using **Endurance + Willpower**. For every **2 Success Points** generated (rounded down), heal 1 Light Wound segment on Physical or Mental Condition.
- **Day-to-Day Pacing (Long Rest):** During extended downtime, operatives gain access to Greater Healing. Roll a **Success Test** using **Endurance + Willpower**. Generated Success Points can be allocated freely:
  - **1 Success Point:** Heals 1 Light Wound segment.
  - **2 Success Points:** Clears 1 Aggravated Wound segment.

  Dedicated ship medbays and planetary clinics provide additional diagnostic bonuses.

CONDITION & RECOVERY IN ACTION

During a fierce orbital warehouse raid, Jax takes **8 physical damage** from a close-range shotgun blast. Jax has an **Endurance of 3**, giving his Physical Condition three sequential Tracks of **7 segments each** (4 + 3).

The first 7 points of damage fill **Track I** completely with Light Wounds. Jax marks his **Strength** Attribute as **Impaired**, meaning any future test involving Strength suffers **1 Downgrade**.

The 1 point of overflow damage turns 1 Light Wound on Track I into an **Aggravated Wound** (leaving Track I with 6 Light Wounds and 1 Aggravated Wound). Any subsequent damage will now overflow into Track II.

Later, back aboard their cutter during a **Long Rest**, Jax makes an **Endurance (3) + Willpower (2)** Success Test rolled with his lower Attribute (**Willpower 2**), rolling `[4, 9]`. The `9` yields **9 base Success Points**.

Jax spends **2 Success Points** to clear the 1 Aggravated Wound on Track I (costing 2 SP per segment), and spends **6 Success Points** to heal the remaining 6 Light Wounds on Track I (costing 1 SP per segment).

Because Track I is completely cleared and no longer full, Jax removes the **Impaired** condition from his Strength Attribute, restoring his rolls to full baseline capability.

TRAITS CATALOG

Beyond raw Attributes and learned Skills, operatives are defined by unique Traits—specialized operational doctrines, combat reflexes, and tactical habits forged on the fringe.

Traits grant distinctive mechanical exceptions, alter action economies, enhance team coordination, or unlock decisive reactions.

ACQUIRING TRAITS

Operatives acquire Traits by spending **Experience Points (XP)**. Each Trait is an independent asset with a flat XP cost between 2 XP and 8 XP. There are no prerequisite trees or artificial gatekeeping:

- **Character Creation:** Spend your starting XP pool (6 XP base; 8 XP hybrids; 10 XP humans) on any Traits.
- **Campaign Advancement:** Spend earned mission XP during day-to-day downtime training to unlock new Traits permanently.

TRAITS IN ACTION: CATWALK INTERDICTION

Jax breaches an orbital cargo bay holding the **Duelist** (3 XP) and **Counter Striker** (4 XP) Traits.

Rushing onto an isolated gantry to intercept an outlaw enforcer, Jax and the target are the only occupants on that space, immediately activating **Duelist** for **+2 Upgrades** on his melee strike.

When the outlaw counter-attacks with a combat knife rolling a single Hit (an 8), Jax spends 1 AP to react with a **Contest Roll**, rolling `[4, 7, 9]`. Scoring a `9`, Jax eliminates the outlaw's Hit. Thanks to **Counter Striker**, Jax doesn't just parry—he redirects the blade's momentum to deal **9 damage** (his highest contest die) directly to the attacker.

MELEE COMBAT TRAITS

Optimized for hand-to-hand engagements, boarding operations, and close-quarters scuffles:

BRAWLER

Cost: 2 XP

You cannot be outnumbered in melee; hostile creatures gain no Upgrades from Outnumbering when attacking you.

COMBO MASTER

Cost: 5 XP

You can spend one **Gambit** die to perform an additional melee attack (paying 1 AP as normal), even if the Player Turn would normally end.

COUNTER STRIKER

Cost: 4 XP

If you fully eliminate all Hits when contesting a melee attack, you can deal damage to one attacking creature equal to the highest value you rolled on the **Contest Roll**.

DUELIST

Cost: 3 XP

You gain +2 **Upgrades** on all melee attacks and contests against a creature in your space if you two are the only ones occupying that space.

INTERCEPTOR

Cost: 2 XP

When you successfully contest a creature's movement, you can deal damage to that creature equal to the highest value you rolled on the **Contest Roll**.

STRIKER

Cost: 3 XP

Your unarmed attacks deal bonus damage equal to your **Endurance**.

RANGED COMBAT & ORDNANCE

These traits refine firearms handling, tactical marksmanship, and the lethal deployment of heavy explosives under suppressive fire.

MARKSMAN

Cost: 4 XP

You can treat your target as being one **Range Band** closer or further for the purpose of determining weapon **Accuracy**.

RAPID FIRE

Cost: 6 XP

You can spend one **Gambit** die to perform an additional ranged attack (paying 1 AP as normal), even if the Player Turn would normally end.

GUNSLINGER

Cost: 4 XP

You ignore the 3 Downgrades for firing a ranged weapon while engaged in Close Quarters Combat (CQC).

SHARPSHOOTER

Cost: 7 XP

You ignore Protection bonuses granted by cover and the 2 Downgrades from firing into Close Quarters Combat (CQC).

BOMBARDIER

Cost: 3 XP

When you activate a **Crit Effect** on a test made with Ordnance, each spent Hit increases Success Points (damage) by +3 instead of +2.

CONTROLLED BLAST

Cost: 8 XP

When you use an item or ability that deals damage to all creatures in one or more spaces, you can choose any number of creatures in the area of effect to be completely unaffected by the blast.

DEFENSE & RESILIENCE

Bolstering physical endurance, mental grit, and bodyguard interception when under heavy hostile barrage.

BODYGUARD

Cost: 5 XP

When you contest an attack targeting an ally in your space, you gain +2 **Upgrades** on your **Contest Roll**.

IRON WILL

Cost: 4 XP

You gain +2 **Willpower**. This does not increase any other Attributes.

STOIC

Cost: 5 XP

You gain Mental Protection equal to your **Willpower**.

LIGHTNING REFLEXES

Cost: 8 XP

Once per round, you can contest one incoming attack targeting you without spending an Action Point (0 AP).

TOUGH AS NAILS

Cost: 6 XP

You gain +2 **Endurance**. This does not increase any other Attributes.

THICK SKIN

Cost: 7 XP

You gain Physical Protection equal to your **Endurance** while not wearing armor.

STEALTH & INFILTRATION

Specialized doctrines for operatives moving through enemy sensor sweeps and ventilation shafts.

SEASONED STALKER

Cost: 5 XP

If the turn ends with you hidden from all non-ally creatures, you can pay one **Gambit** die to take one more action, paying its Action Point cost (1 AP) as normal.

SNEAK ATTACK

Cost: 3 XP

When you make an attack against a creature that has not detected you yet, the attack deals +3 bonus damage.

MEDICAL & FIELD SUPPORT

HEALER

Cost: 4 XP

Once per round, when you heal your own or another creature's Physical or Mental Condition, you can heal one additional segment.

TEAMWORK & LEADERSHIP

Synchronizing fireteams, executing delayed actions, and pooling tactical momentum.

COORDINATOR

Cost: 3 XP

When you take part in a **Teamwork** Action, every other participant receives 1 **Upgrade**.

LEADER

Cost: 5 XP

Once per round, when you take part in a **Teamwork** Action, a chosen ally can join the action without spending an Action Point (0 AP).

PLANNER

Cost: 3 XP

When two or more Delayed Actions are triggered in the same turn, you gain a d10 **Gambit** die.

HEART OF THE TEAM

Cost: 4 XP

Allies can freely transfer any Gambit dice they earn to your **Gambit** pool, and you can transfer **Gambit** dice from your pool to allies whenever they are eligible to spend Gambit.

SOCIAL & NEGOTIATION

CLOSER

Cost: 5 XP

You can spend one **Gambit** die to perform a test that involves communication (paying 1 AP as normal), even if the Player Turn would normally end.

IMPRESSIVE

Cost: 2 XP

Your first social interaction test with a creature you have never met before gains +1 **Upgrade**.

GAMBIT & MOMENTUM

CALLED SHOT

Cost: 4 XP

When you add a **Gambit** die to a dice pool before rolling, you can re-roll that **Gambit** die once after the roll.

DOUBLE DOWN

Cost: 5 XP

When you spend two or more **Gambit** dice on a single test, those **Gambit** dice step up to d12s.

DRAW TWO

Cost: 4 XP

When you earn a **Gambit** die, if your **Gambit** pool was previously empty, you gain an additional d8 **Gambit** die.

CHARACTER ADVANCEMENT

As operatives execute warrants, survive firefights, and navigate corporate intrigues, they accumulate Experience Points (XP) to advance their innate capabilities.

EARNING EXPERIENCE POINTS

XP is earned through two primary engines: **operational missions** and **downtime training**.

MISSIONS & CONTRACT TIERS

When a cell successfully completes an operational warrant, each participating operative receives a flat XP award based on threat tier:

CONTRACT THREAT TIERS & REWARDS

TIER	SCOPE & THREAT LEVEL	XP AWARD	REPUTATION
Tier 1	Local interdictions, precinct patrol, minor asset recovery	**+4 XP**	+1 to +2 Rep
Tier 2	Cross-jurisdictional strikes, black-ops, hostile boardings	**+8 XP**	+3 to +5 Rep
Tier 3	Systemic crises, Precursor incursions, fleet actions	**+12 XP**	+7 to +10 Rep

DOWNTIME TRAINING DRILLS

Between contracts, operatives can spend downtime studying tactical theory or practicing combat drills. Spending **1 Day-to-Day Action Point (AP)** on training awards **1 XP**.

- **Strict Daily Limit:** To reflect biological conditioning limits, an operative can earn a **maximum of 1 XP from Training per 24-hour round** (spending at most 1 Day-to-Day AP on training). The remaining 2 AP must be allocated to other activities (medical rest, starship maintenance, odd jobs, personal research).
- **Closing the Gap:** Downtime training serves primarily to top off the final 1 or 2 XP needed for a new Trait, Skill rank, or Attribute increase before deployment.

IMPROVING ATTRIBUTES

To improve an Attribute, pay XP equal to **three times the new target level**. You can only advance one level at a time:

ATTRIBUTE ADVANCEMENT COSTS

TARGET LEVEL	XP REQUIRED	NARRATIVE CAPABILITY SCALE
Level 2	6 XP	Basic operational competency.
Level 3	9 XP	Standard field agent proficiency.
Level 4	12 XP	Highly trained veteran specialist.
Level 5	15 XP	Elite sector-level capability.
Level 6	18 XP	Master-class human conditioning.
Level 7	21 XP	Peak biological performance.
Level 8	24 XP	The absolute physical/cybernetic limit.

LEARNING & UPGRADING SKILLS

To learn or improve a Skill, pay XP equal to **two times the new target level**. Advance one level at a time:

SKILL ADVANCEMENT COSTS

TARGET LEVEL	XP REQUIRED	FIELD COMPETENCY SCALE
Level 1	2 XP	Basic field familiarity (+1 Upgrade).
Level 2	4 XP	Advanced specialist standard (+2 Upgrades).
Level 3	6 XP	Elite master-class authority (+3 Upgrades).

CHASSIS HARDWARE UPGRADES

In Corsair, your Class is manufactured hardware interfacing with your neural port—not biological experience. Consequently, chassis do not advance via XP.

Operatives upgrade their MANTLE chassis by financing precision biomedical retrofits, micro-machined parts, and firmware overclocks with **Credits** during day-to-day downtime.

STANDARDIZED CHASSIS PROGRESSION

All five MANTLE chassis follow an identical five-tier upgrade path:

CHASSIS LEVEL PROGRESSION

LEVEL	BENEFITS UNLOCKED	COST	MILESTONE
Level 1	Base Chassis, 7 Attribute Points (1/1/1 base), Starting Package, Engine	**Free***	Commissioning as an operative.
Level 2	+1 Class Attribute Point, +1 Ability Package (3 Abilities)	**20,000 Cr**	Field-tested optimization.
Level 3	+1 Class Attribute Point, +1 Mod Slot (Slot 1), +1 Ability Package	**40,000 Cr**	Unlocks first signature overclock.
Level 4	+1 Class Attribute Point, +1 Ability Package (All Packages Unlocked)	**75,000 Cr**	Complete omnirole flexibility.
Level 5	+1 Class Attribute Point, +1 Mod Slot (Slot 2)	**150,000 Cr**	Dual-overclock peak capability.

*The Level 1 chassis chosen at character creation is free. Purchasing an additional chassis during downtime costs 100,000 Credits.

CLASS MODS (HARDWARE OVERCLOCKS)

Class Mods represent high-end firmware alterations and mechanical customizations that bend the chassis's core operating rules:

- **Fixed Cost:** Each Class Mod costs **25,000 Credits**.
- **Mod Sockets:** Operatives unlock **Mod Slot 1 at Level 3** and **Mod Slot 2 at Level 5**, supporting up to two active mods simultaneously per chassis.
- **Swapping Mods:** Operatives can freely swap between owned mods during day-to-day downtime at zero cost.

CHASSIS OWNERSHIP & SWAPPING

Due to metabolic strain and neural bandwidth limits, an operative can have **only one active chassis equipped at a time**.

During downtime, an operative can purchase additional chassis frames for **100,000 Credits** each and calibrate them to their neural port. Upgraded levels, attribute ratings, and installed mods are tied to each physical chassis frame and are permanently preserved whenever an operative swaps suits in the hangar.

> **THE CREDIT ECONOMY BALANCE**
>
> Because gear, starship components, and chassis levels all compete for earned contract Credits, players face meaningful strategic decisions between buying heavy ordnance, upgrading their personal MANTLE frame, or investing in the cell's shared starship.

CELL ADVANCEMENT & STANDING

While individual operatives advance their personal conditioning and gear, the Corsair Cell also possesses its own collective advancement system.

The Cell is both an asset and an investment in the eyes of its Sponsors. Cells hold a letter-grade clearance rank from **Grade D to Grade S**, advancing based on accumulated **Reputation**.

THE REPUTATION LADDER

Crossing reputation thresholds triggers a formal **Rank Evaluation** with your Sponsors:

RANK PROMOTION REWARDS & CLEARANCES

RANK	REP	DISCRETIONARY BONUS	SHIP FUNDS	MARKET CLEARANCE
Grade D	0–14	—	—	Greenhorn charter; local contracts.
Grade C	15 Rep	$20,000 Cr / op	$5,000,000 Cr	Regional trade networks, commercial hull mods.
Grade B	40 Rep	$45,000 Cr / op	$10,000,000 Cr	Restricted EW packages, medium frigate hulls.
Grade A	75 Rep	$75,000 Cr / op	$25,000,000 Cr	Military spinal mounts, heavy destroyers.
Grade S	120 Rep	$100,000 Cr / op	$50,000,000 Cr	Sponsor black-tech, flagship-tier hulls.

Discretionary Bonuses are distributed directly to each operative. **Ship Funds** are restricted strictly to purchasing, repairing, and refitting the cell's starship.

POST-GRADE S PRESTIGE: THE LEGEND CYCLE

Achieving Grade S represents the summit of the Sphere's operational hierarchy. To reward continued legendary service:

- **The Legend Cycle:** Every time a Grade S Cell accumulates an additional **+30 Reputation** beyond the 120 baseline (e.g., hitting 150, 180, 210 Rep), they trigger a **Prestige Evaluation**.
- **The Recurring Payday:** Clearing this evaluation grants each operative a fresh **$100,000 Credit Discretionary Bonus**, and injects **$20,000,000 Credits** into the ship fund.
- **High Stakes:** Reputation losses are doubled for an active Grade S Cell.

REPUTATION FLUX & DEMOTIONS

Reputation is volatile and reflects institutional trust:

- **Mission Rewards:** Tier 1 (+1 Rep), Tier 2 (+3 Rep), Tier 3 (+7 Rep), with sponsor bonus consensus adding up to +1 to +3 Rep.
- **Objective Failure:** -2 to -5 Rep (asset destroyed, target escapes).
- **Illegal Activity:** -3 to -8 Rep (caught operating outside mandate).
- **Sponsor Slight:** -1 to -3 Rep (defying sponsor directives).
- **Idle Penalties:** If a full **5-Day Upkeep Cycle** passes without completing a contract, standing decays.
- **Rank Demotions:** If Reputation drops below a rank threshold, the cell enters a 1-cycle grace period to restore standing. Failing to recover strips the rank. A cell falling below Grade D is expelled from the Corsair program.